

Hippocampus satomiei

Satomi's pygmy seahorse



Length ½ in (1.4 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Data deficient

Location S.E. Asia



Described in 2008 on the basis of specimens collected in Indonesia, this—the smallest known species of seahorse—is a nocturnal inhabitant of coral reefs. At night, it gathers in small groups on sea fans below reef overhangs at depths of 49–66 ft (15–20 m). Newborn young are black, but become paler and browner as they grow older—providing camouflage in their coral habitat.

Hippocampus guttulatus

Long-snouted seahorse



Length Up to 6½ in (16 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Data deficient

Location E. North Atlantic, Mediterranean, Black Sea



Long-snouted seahorses are remarkable fish, with pipette-shaped mouths, horselike heads, and bodies covered with bony plates. They feed on planktonic animals, and swim upright, propelled by tiny fins. Most species live among eel grass and seaweed, and anchor themselves with their prehensile tails. Like their close relatives, the pipefish, they have unusual breeding behavior. In the long-snouted seahorse, the female lays the eggs in the male's brood pouch, at the base of his tail. He carries these until the young hatch.



Phyllopteryx taeniolatus

Weedy seadragon



Length Up to 18 in (46 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Near threatened

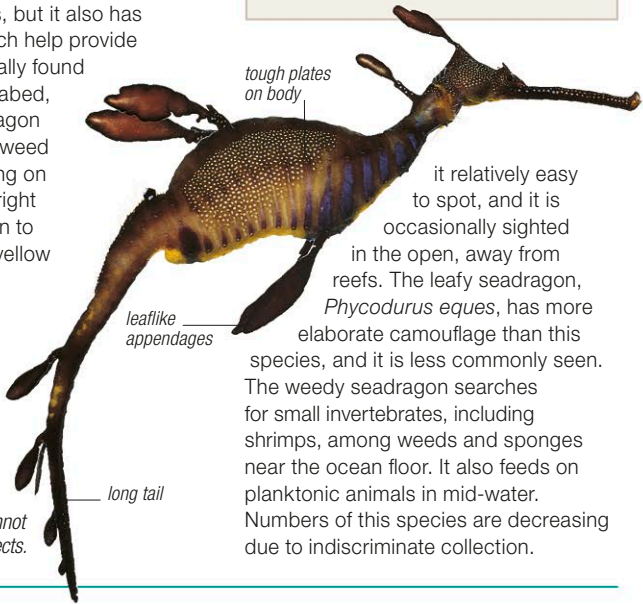
Location S. Australia



The weedy or common seadragon is one of the largest seahorses, and one of the most bizarrely shaped. Like other seahorses, its body is covered with toughened plates, but it also has leaflike flaps, which help provide camouflage. Usually found just above the seabed, the weedy seadragon hides among seaweed and plants growing on rocky reefs. Its bright coloration—brown to orange-red with yellow spotting—does, however, make

LEAFY PROTRUSIONS

The weedy seadragon is named for the leaflike appendages on its body. Unlike other seahorses, its tail cannot be coiled around objects.



After mating takes place, the fertilized eggs are attached to the wrinkled undersurface of the male's tail and carried around by him. As the eggs hatch, the baby seadragons swim away.

it is relatively easy to spot, and it is occasionally sighted in the open, away from reefs. The leafy seadragon, *Phycodurus eques*, has more elaborate camouflage than this species, and it is less commonly seen. The weedy seadragon searches for small invertebrates, including shrimps, among weeds and sponges near the ocean floor. It also feeds on planktonic animals in mid-water. Numbers of this species are decreasing due to indiscriminate collection.

Aulostomus chinensis

Trumpetfish



Length Up to 32 in (80 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Pacific, Indian Ocean



The trumpetfish is a common reef predator that often conceals itself by floating with its head vertically down among the branches of sea fans and other corals. It has a long, slender, flattened body, and a small mouth at the end of a very long snout. It is generally brown, but some are completely yellow. The trumpetfish hunts by ambush, lying motionless in water like a piece of drifting wood; it is galvanized into sudden action by passing schools of fishes.

Aeoliscus strigatus

Razorfish



Length Up to 6 in (15 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Data deficient

Location W. Pacific



This fish spends much of its time swimming with its head vertically downwards. Schools of

razorfishes move in synchrony while feeding on tiny crustaceans drifting in the plankton. When inactive, they hide head-down among corals and between the spines of sea urchins. The long, narrow body and elongated snout are adaptations to this lifestyle. The belly has a sharp edge, and that gives this fish its common name. A dark stripe runs along the body, and when out over sand, the body turns pale for better camouflage. The body is almost entirely covered by thin, transparent plates; only the underside of the tail region is free of this armor to allow for fin movement.



Scomber scombrus

Atlantic mackerel



Length Up to 23½ in (60 cm)
Weight Up to 7¼ lb (3.5 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location North Atlantic, Mediterranean, Black Sea



Atlantic mackerel are streamlined predatory fishes that inhabit cold waters and continental shelf areas. In spring, they migrate closer to the shore. Mackerel group in large schools



according to size, feeding on fish larvae and small crustaceans. Spawning occurs from March to June when females lay as many as 450,000 eggs in a season. This commercially important species is extensively fished throughout its range.

Thunnus thynnus

Atlantic bluefin tuna



Length Up to 14 ft (4.3 m)
Weight Up to 2,010 lb (910 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Endangered

Location Atlantic



The Atlantic bluefin tuna is one of the world's largest and fastest bony fishes, reaching speeds of at

least 43 mph (70 kph). It has a powerful and streamlined body. Its pectoral and pelvic fins and its first dorsal fin can be recessed into grooves to minimize drag. Swimming in schools, the tuna migrates as far as 6,250 miles (10,000 km) across ocean basins, feeding on open-water fishes. In recent years, overfishing has led to a drastic decline in population.

